

Command Palette & Essentials

⇧P	Command Palette (everything lives here)
⇧P	Quick Open file by name
,	Settings UI
⌘K ⌘S	Keyboard shortcuts editor
⌘K ⌘O	Open folder
⇧⌘N	New window
⇧⌘W	Close window
F1	Same as ⇧⇧P

Tip: in the palette, prefix with > for commands, : for line, @ for symbol, # for workspace symbol.

Navigation

⇧P	Go to file (fuzzy)
⇧⌘O	Go to symbol in file
⇧T	Go to symbol in workspace
⇧G	Go to line number
⌘-	Navigate back
⇧⌘-	Navigate forward
F12	Go to definition
⇧F12	Peek definition
⇧F12	Go to implementation
⌘K F12	Open definition in split

Editing & Multi-Cursor

⇧↑ / ⇧↓	Move line up / down
⇧⇧↑ / ⇧⇧↓	Copy line up / down
⇧⇧K	Delete line
⇧Enter	Insert line below
⇧⇧Enter	Insert line above
⇧/	Toggle line comment
⇧⇧A	Toggle block comment
⇧D	Add next match to selection
⇧⇧L	Select all occurrences
⌘K ⇧D	Skip current, select next match
⇧+click	Add cursor at click
⇧⇧↑ / ⇧⇧↓	Add cursor above / below
⇧⇧+drag	Column (box) selection
⇧] / ⇧[	Indent / outdent
⇧L	Select current line
⇧⇧⇧→ / ⇧⇧⇧←	Expand / shrink selection

Search & Replace

⇧F	Find in file
⇧⇧F	Replace in file
⇧⇧⇧F	Find in files (workspace)
⇧⇧⇧H	Replace in files
⇧Enter	(in Find) Select all matches
⇧⇧C	Toggle case-sensitive
⇧⇧W	Toggle whole-word
⇧⇧R	Toggle regex
⇧G / ⇧⇧G	Next / previous match

Regex: \$1, \$2 for capture groups in replace. Use \n for newlines (multiline mode).

Integrated Terminal

⇧`	Toggle terminal
⇧⇧`	New terminal
⇧\	Split terminal
⇧K	Clear terminal (when focused)
⇧⇧]/[	Next / previous terminal
⇧↑ / ⇧↓	Scroll page up / down
⇧W	Kill terminal

Default shell on macOS is zsh. Set bash via Terminal: Select Default Profile in the palette.

Remote-SSH (RHEL boxes)

>Remote-SSH: Connect to Host	Connect to a server
>Remote-SSH: Open SSH Config File	Edit ~/.ssh/config
>Remote-SSH: Kill VS Code Remote-SSH Server	Restart server on host
bottom-left ><	Connection indicator
⇧P then 'Reload'	Reconnect after VPN/sleep

Server runs ~/.vscode-server on the host. If /home is full or NFS-backed, set "remote.SSH.serverInstallPath" per host.

Source Control (Git & SVN)

⇧⇧G	Source Control panel
⇧Enter	(in message box) Commit staged
>Git: Stage All Changes	git add -A
>Git: Push	Push current branch
>Git: Checkout to...	Switch branch
>SVN: Refresh	Refresh working copy status
>SVN: Update	svn up
>SVN: Commit	svn ci with message

Install 'GitLens' for inline blame; for SVN, install 'SVN' by johnstoncode.

View & Layout

⇧B	Toggle sidebar
⇧J	Toggle bottom panel
⇧\	Split editor right
⇧1 / ⇧2	Focus editor group 1 / 2
⇧W	Close editor
⇧K ⇧W	Close all editors
⇧⇧T	Reopen closed editor
⇧K Z	Zen mode (Esc Esc to exit)
⇧⇧F	Full screen
⇧= / ⇧-	Zoom in / out
⇧K ⇧O	Fold all
⇧K ⇧J	Unfold all

Diff, Compare & Merge

>File: Compare Active File with...	Diff against another file
>Compare with Clipboard	Diff vs paste buffer
F7 / ⇧F7	Next / previous change in diff
⇧F5	Next merge conflict

In Explorer: right-click a file → 'Select for Compare', then right-click another → 'Compare with Selected'.

Tasks, Build & Debug

■ ■ B	Run build task
>Tasks: Run Task	Pick from tasks.json
F5	Start debugging
F9	Toggle breakpoint
F10	Step over
F11	Step into
■ F11	Step out
■ F5	Stop

Bash / Shell Scripting

timonwong.shellcheck	Real-time shellcheck linting
foxundermoon.shell-format	Format with shfmt
mads-hartmann.bash-ide-vscode	Build language server
rogalmic.bash-debug	Step-debug bash scripts
formulahendry.code-runner	Run selection / file

Set "files.associations": { "*.sh": "shellcheck" }; pin shellcheck severity via "shellcheck.customArgs": ["-x"] for sourced files.

settings.json — sysadmin starter

```
{
  "editor.renderWhitespace": "boundary",
  "editor.rulers": [80, 120],
  "editor.tabSize": 2,
  "editor.insertSpaces": true,
  "files.trimTrailingWhitespace": true,
  "files.insertFinalNewline": true,
  "files.eol": "\n",
  "files.associations": {
    "*.cron": "shellscript",
    ".env*": "dotenv"
  },
  "terminal.integrated.scrollback": 50000,
  "terminal.integrated.copyOnSelection": true,
  "remote.SSH.connectTimeout": 30,
  "remote.SSH.remotePlatform": { "rhel7-host": "linux" },
  "shellcheck.enable": true,
  "shellformat.flag": "-i 2 -ci -bn"
}
```

Power Tips

■ K M	Change file language (e.g. log → log)
■ K V	Open Markdown preview to side
■ K R	Reveal file in Finder
■ K P	Copy path of current file
■ ■ E	Focus Explorer
■ ■ X	Extensions panel

>Developer: Reload Window Soft restart

>Preferences: Open Profile Switcher Switch profile (sysadmin/dev)

Profiles isolate extensions/settings — handy for an 'ops' profile (Remote-SSH, shellcheck, SVN) vs a 'dev' profile.

Recommended Extensions

Remote - SSH	Edit on RHEL/HTCondor hosts
Remote - Containers	Dev inside Docker/Podman
GitLens	Inline git blame & history
SVN (johnstoncode)	Subversion in Source Control
Better TOML / YAML	HTCondor-adjacent config files
Log File Highlighter	Color levels in /var/log/* tails
Hex Editor	Inspect binaries from your servers
Path Intellisense	Autocomplete file paths
Code Spell Checker	Catches typos in scripts/docs

When Things Break

>Developer: Reload Window	First thing to try
>Developer: Toggle Dev Tools	Inspect extension errors
>Remote-SSH: Kill VS Code Server on Host	Stop remote host
>Preferences: Configure Remote Arguments	Configure arguments
~/ .vscode/extensions	Wipe to reset extensions
code --disable-extensions	Launch clean

On macOS the binary is at /Applications/Visual Studio Code.app/Contents/Resources/app/bin/code — symlink into /usr/local/bin or add to PATH.